Quarto + Positron

Part of "Getting Started with Positron" workshop

Posit Software, PBC

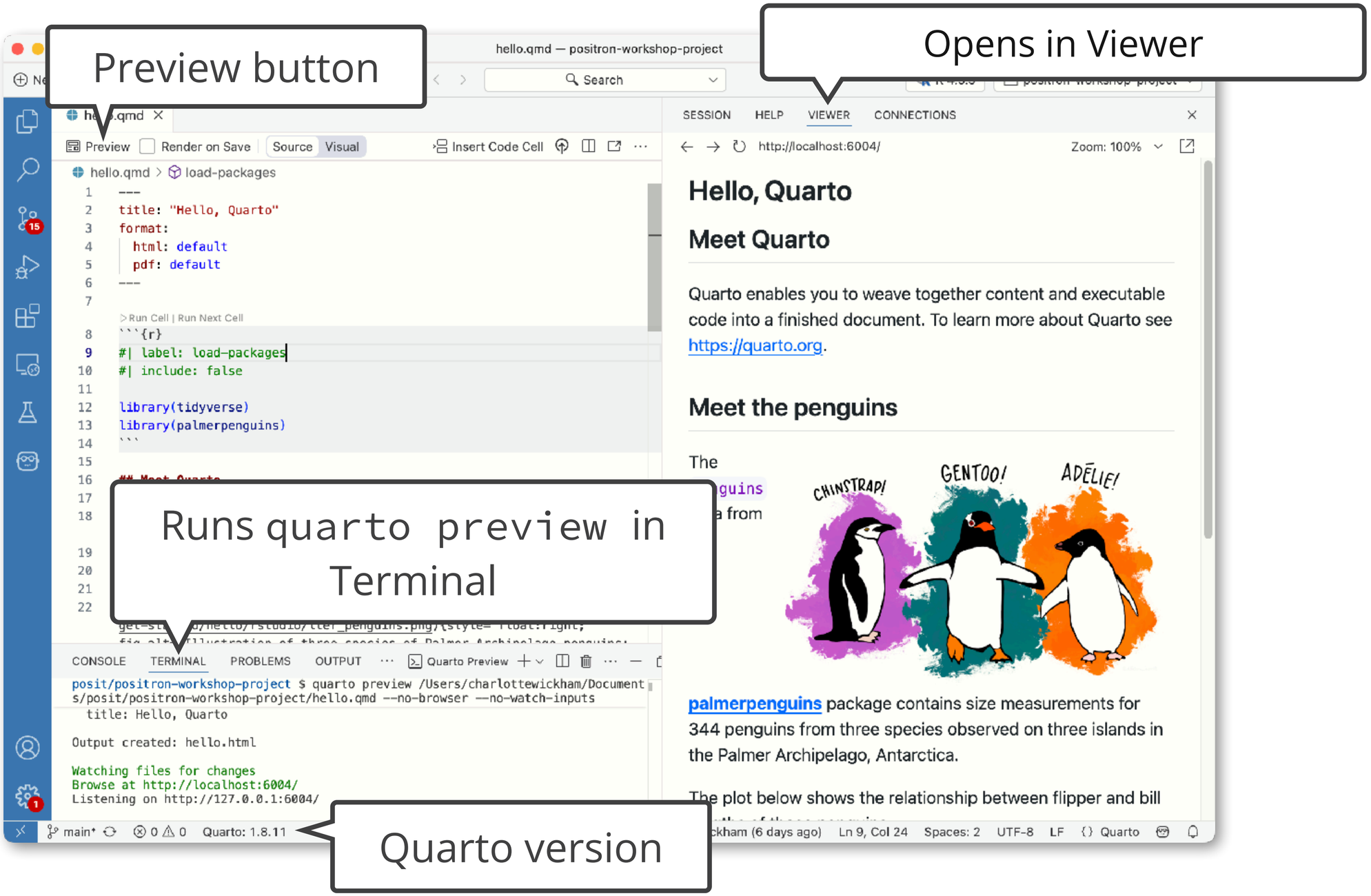
Positron is Quarto-ready out-of-the-box

- Bundles Quarto CLI (or uses Quarto it finds on your path)
- Bundles Quarto VS Code Extension

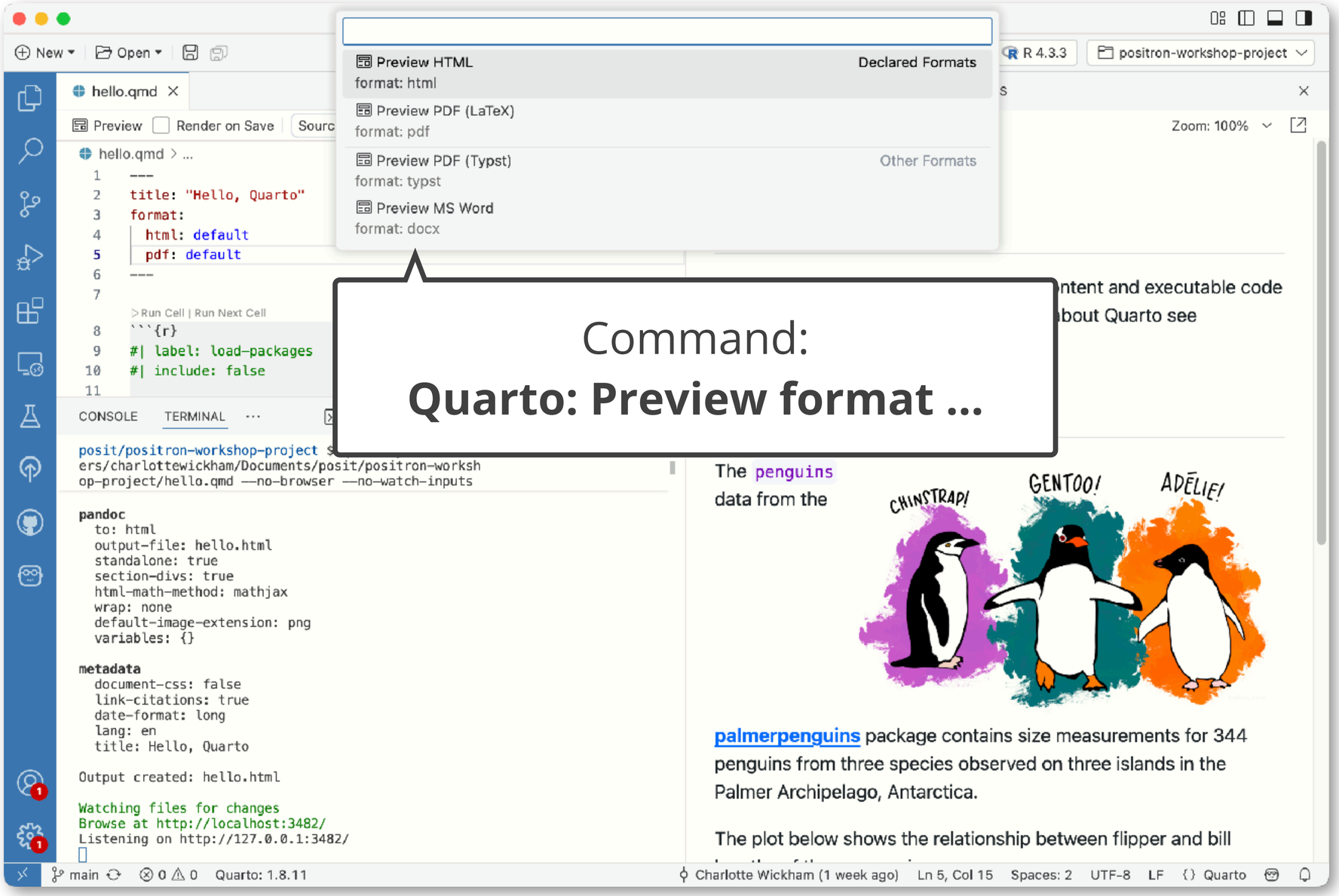
Demo

Basic Workflow

- Open `hello-r.qmd`
- Preview button
  - Quarto commands are run in Terminal pane
  - Preview opens in Viewer pane
- Command: **Quarto: Preview format...**


Preview button
Opens in Viewer
Runs quarto preview in Terminal
Quarto version
hello.qmd — positron-workshop-project
Preview
Render on Save
Source
Visual
Insert Code Cell
hello.qmd > load-packages
---
title: "Hello, Quarto"
format:
html: default
pdf: default

Run Cell | Run Next Cell
```{r}
#| label: load-packages
#| include: false
library(tidyverse)
library(palmerpenguins)
```
CONSOLE
TERMINAL
PROBLEMS
OUTPUT
Quarto Preview
posit/positron-workshop-project $ quarto preview /Users/charlottewickham/Documents/posit/positron-workshop-project/hello.qmd --no-browser --no-watch-inputs
title: Hello, Quarto
Output created: hello.html
Watching files for changes
Browse at http://localhost:6004/
Listening on http://127.0.0.1:6004/
main
Quarto: 1.8.11
SESSION
HELP
VIEWER
CONNECTIONS
http://localhost:6004/
Zoom: 100%
Hello, Quarto
Meet Quarto
Quarto enables you to weave together content and executable code into a finished document. To learn more about Quarto see https://quarto.org.
Meet the penguins
The
CHINSTRAP!
GENTOO!
ADÉLIE!
palmerpenguins package contains size measurements for 344 penguins from three species observed on three islands in the Palmer Archipelago, Antarctica.
The plot below shows the relationship between flipper and bill
Ln 9, Col 24
Spaces: 2
UTF-8
LF
Quarto



Command:

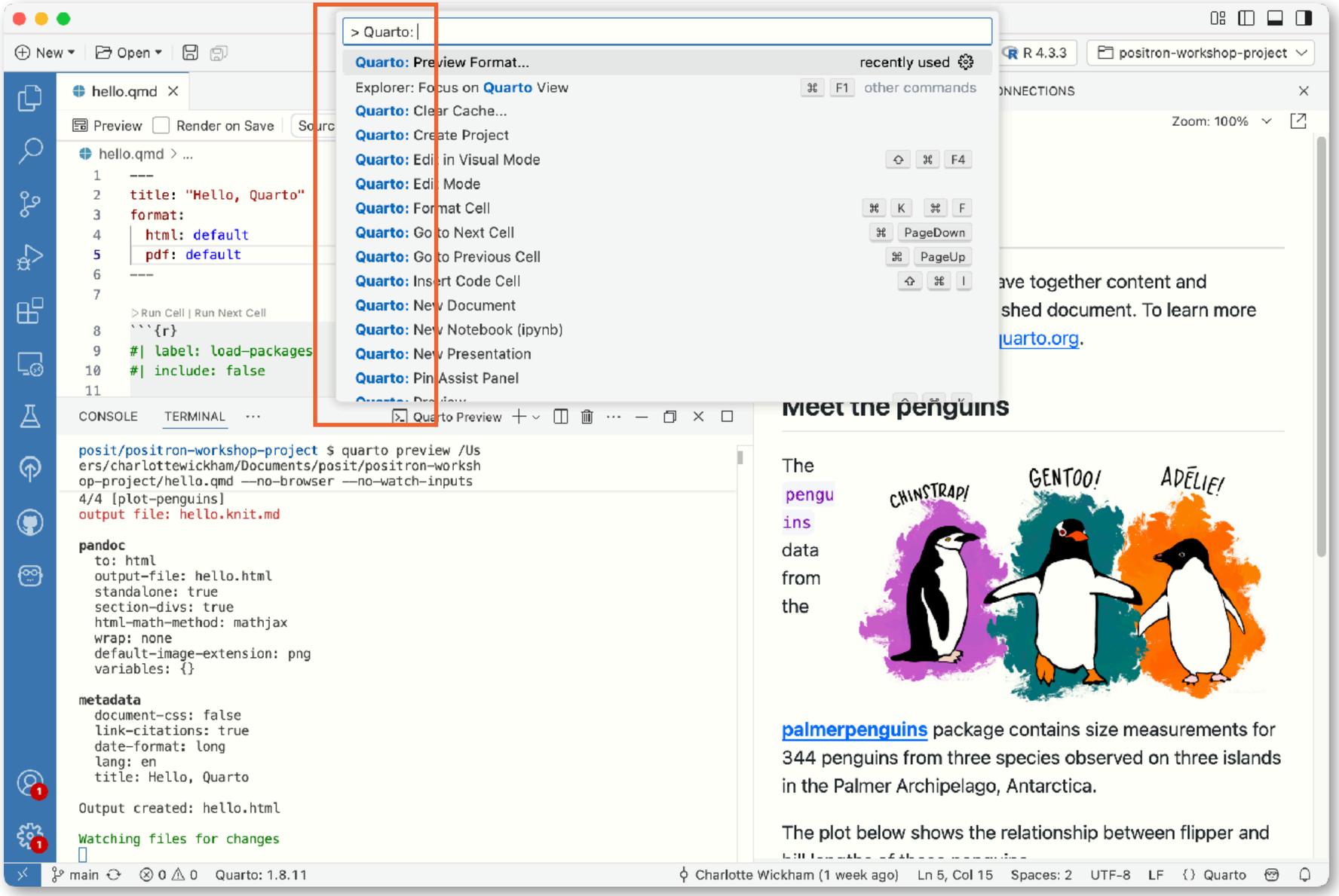
Quarto: Preview format ...

Your turn

Quarto Commands

3m 00s

- Open Command Palette
- Skim **Quarto:** actions
- Pick one and try it


> Quarto:
Quarto: Preview Format...
recently used
Explorer: Focus on Quarto View
other commands
Quarto: Clear Cache...
Quarto: Create Project
Quarto: Edit in Visual Mode
Quarto: Edit Mode
Quarto: Format Cell
Quarto: Go to Next Cell
Quarto: Go to Previous Cell
Quarto: Insert Code Cell
Quarto: New Document
Quarto: New Notebook (ipynb)
Quarto: New Presentation
Quarto: Pin Assist Panel
hello.qmd
---
title: "Hello, Quarto"
format:
html: default
pdf: default

```{r}
#| label: load-packages
#| include: false
posit/positron-workshop-project $ quarto preview /Users/charlottewickham/Documents/posit/positron-workshop-project/hello.qmd --no-browser --no-watch-inputs
4/4 [plot-penguins]
output file: hello.knit.md
pandoc
to: html
output-file: hello.html
standalone: true
section-divs: true
html-math-method: mathjax
wrap: none
default-image-extension: png
variables: {}
metadata
document-css: false
link-citations: true
date-format: long
lang: en
title: Hello, Quarto
Output created: hello.html
Watching files for changes
Meet the penguins
The penguins data from the
CHINSTRAP!
GENTOO!
ADÉLIE!
palmerpenguins package contains size measurements for 344 penguins from three species observed on three islands in the Palmer Archipelago, Antarctica.
The plot below shows the relationship between flipper and
```

Demo

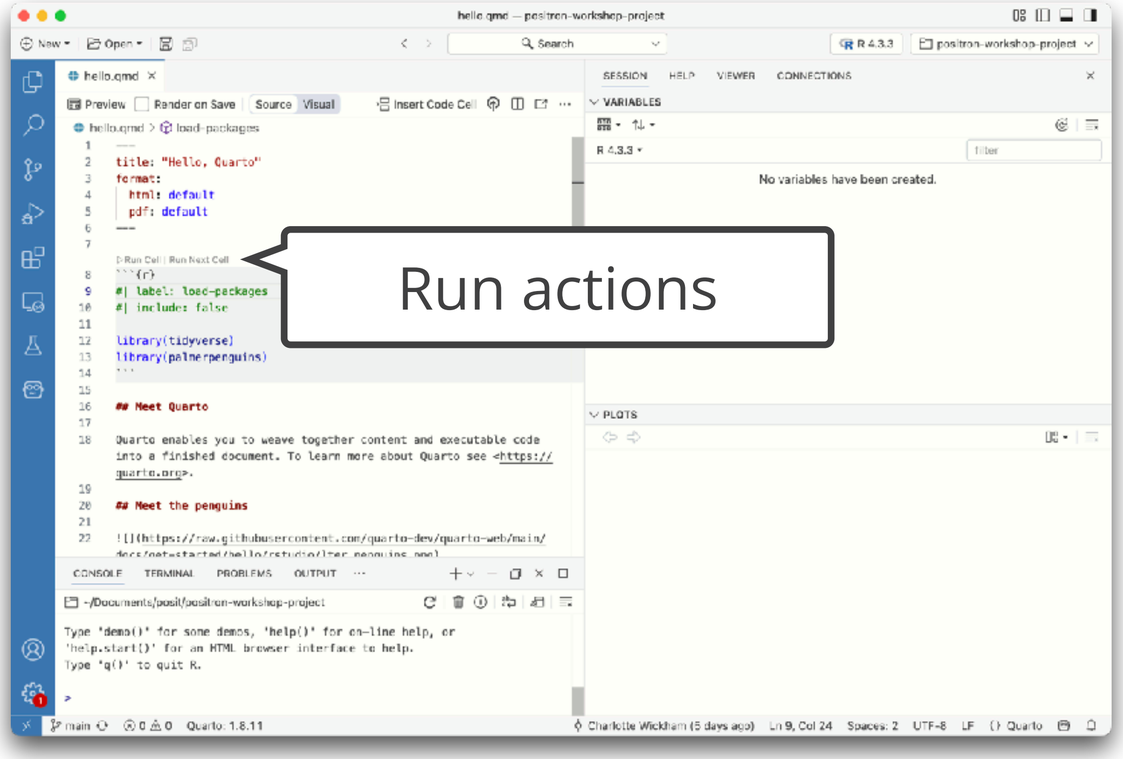
Document Workflow

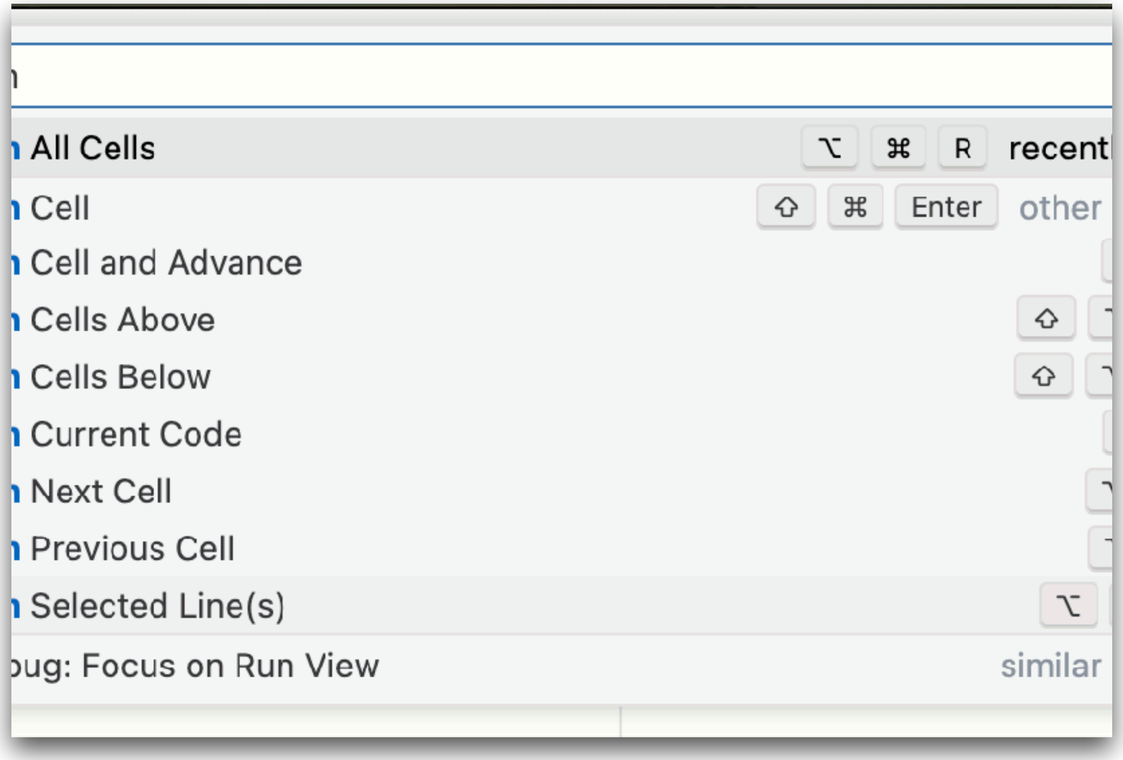
- Code cells
  - Run Selection: `cmd/ctrl+enter`
  - Run Cell: `shift+cmd/ctrl+enter`
  - Command Palette: **Quarto: Run ...**
  - **Preview feature:** Inline output
- Navigation: Breadcrumbs, Outline pane, Command palette: **Go to Symbol in Editor**

Code Cells

Commands:

Quarto: Run ...





Inline output

Settings

Settings

quarto inline

4 Settings Found

User Workspace

Extensions (1)

Quarto (1)

Positron › Quarto › Inline Output: Enabled *Preview*

✔ Enable inline output display for Quarto documents. When enabled, code execution results appear directly in the editor below the executed cell.

Positron › Quarto › Inline Output: Max Lines *Preview*

Maximum number of lines to display in inline text output. If output exceeds this limit, only the last N lines are shown with a link to open the full output in an editor.

40

Quarto › Visual Editor: Markdown Reference Links

Write markdown links as references rather than inline. Reference links are written to the location specified in Quarto › Visual Editor: Markdown References.

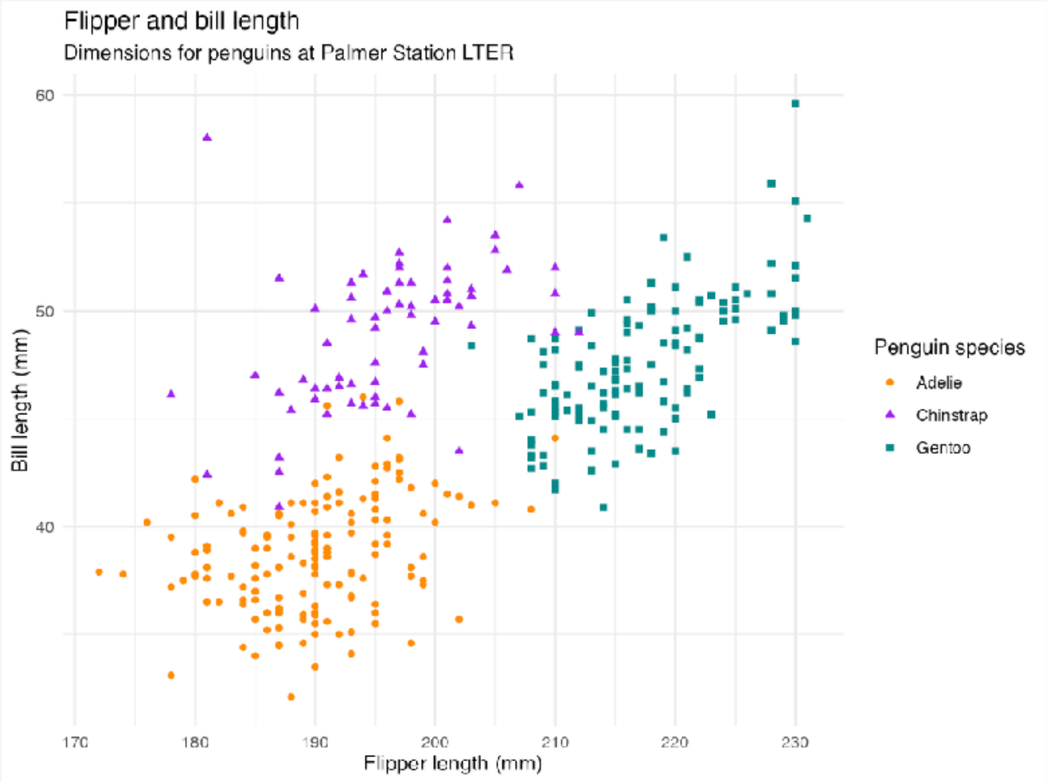
Positron › Notebook › Inline Data Explorer: Max Height

Maximum height in pixels for inline data explorers in notebook and Quarto outputs.

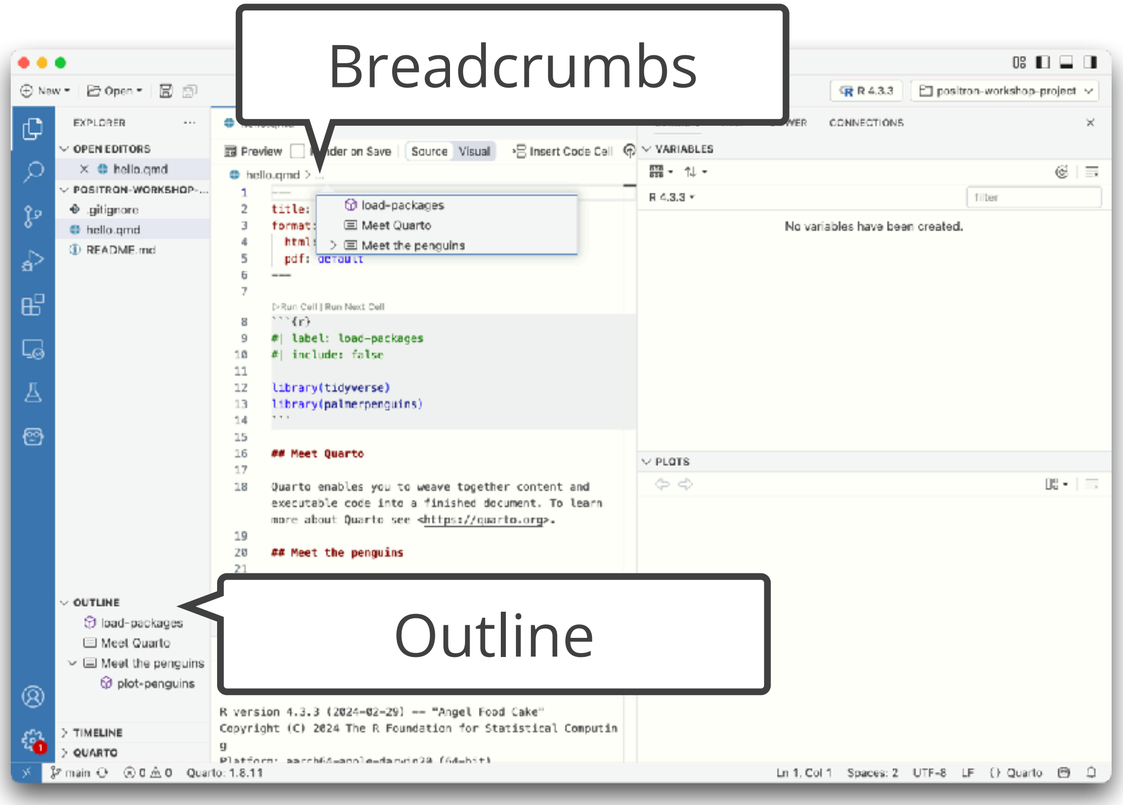
300

```{r}
#| label: plot-penguins
#| warning: false
#| echo: false
ggplot(penguins, aes(x = flipper_length_mm, y = bill_length_mm)) +
  geom_point(aes(color = species, shape = species)) +
  scale_color_manual(values = c("darkorange", "purple", "cyan4")) +
  labs(
    title = "Flipper and bill length",
    subtitle = "Dimensions for penguins at Palmer Station LTER",
    x = "Flipper length (mm)",
    y = "Bill length (mm)",
    color = "Penguin species",
    shape = "Penguin species"
  ) +
  theme_minimal()
```

```
Warning message:
Removed 2 rows containing missing values or values outside the scale range (`geom_point()`).
```

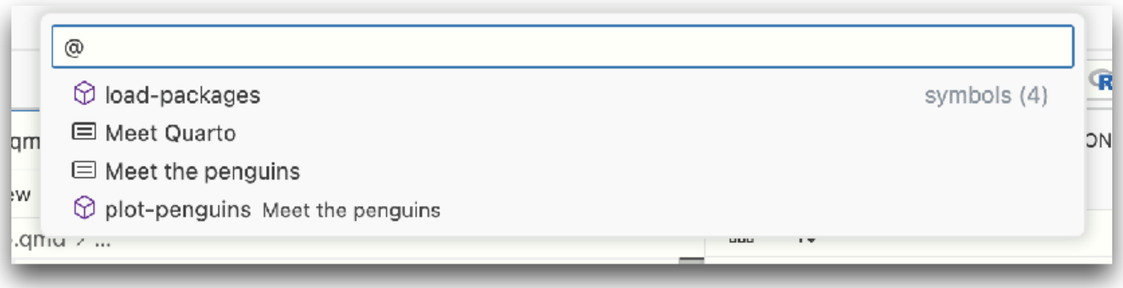


Navigation



Command:

Go to Symbol in Editor



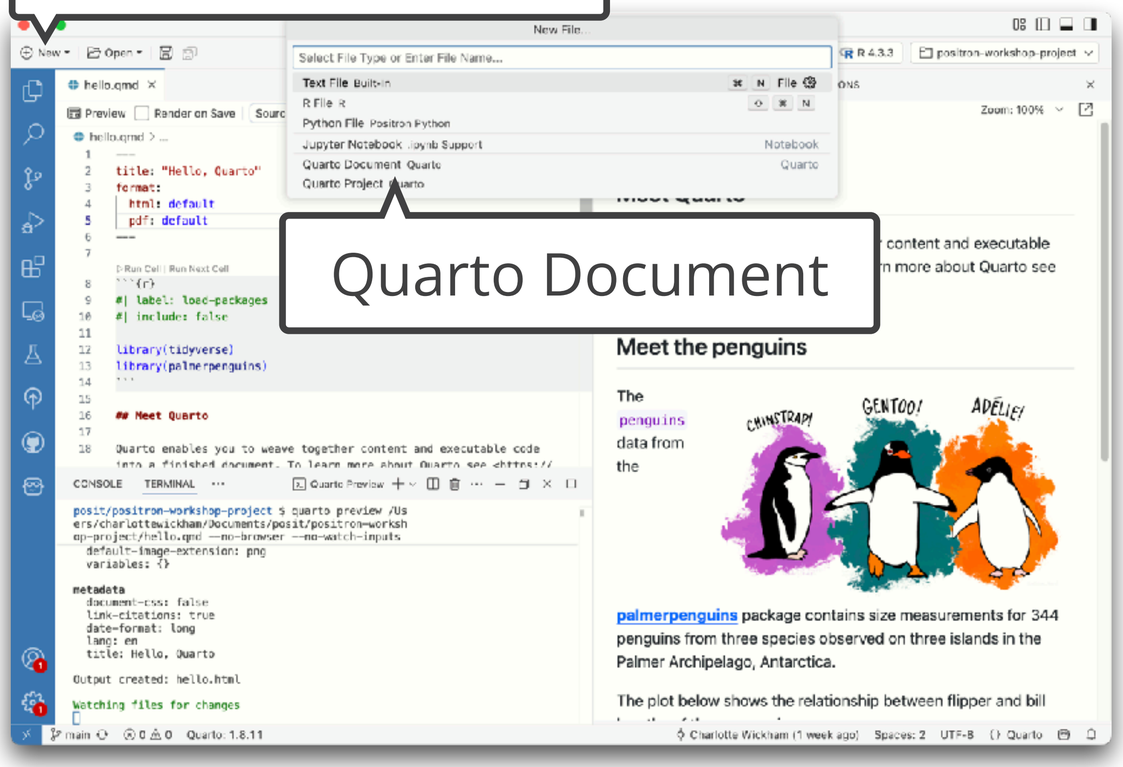
Your turn

Authoring

5m 00s

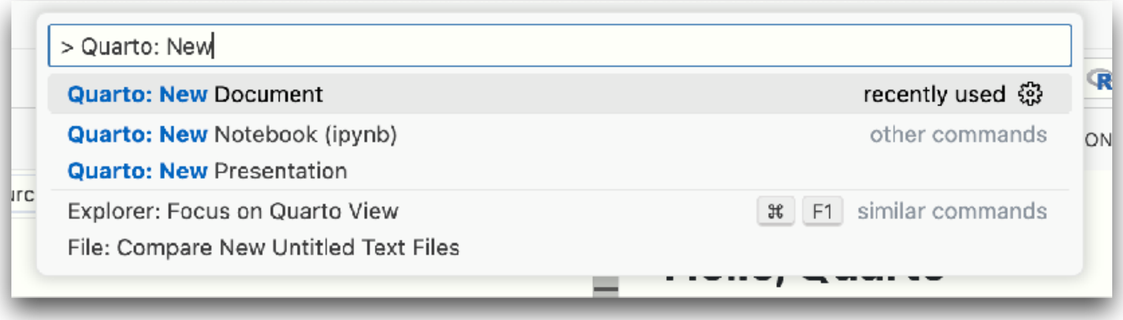
- Figure out how to:
  - Create a new Quarto document
  - Insert a code cell
- Then, practice anything else you've seen

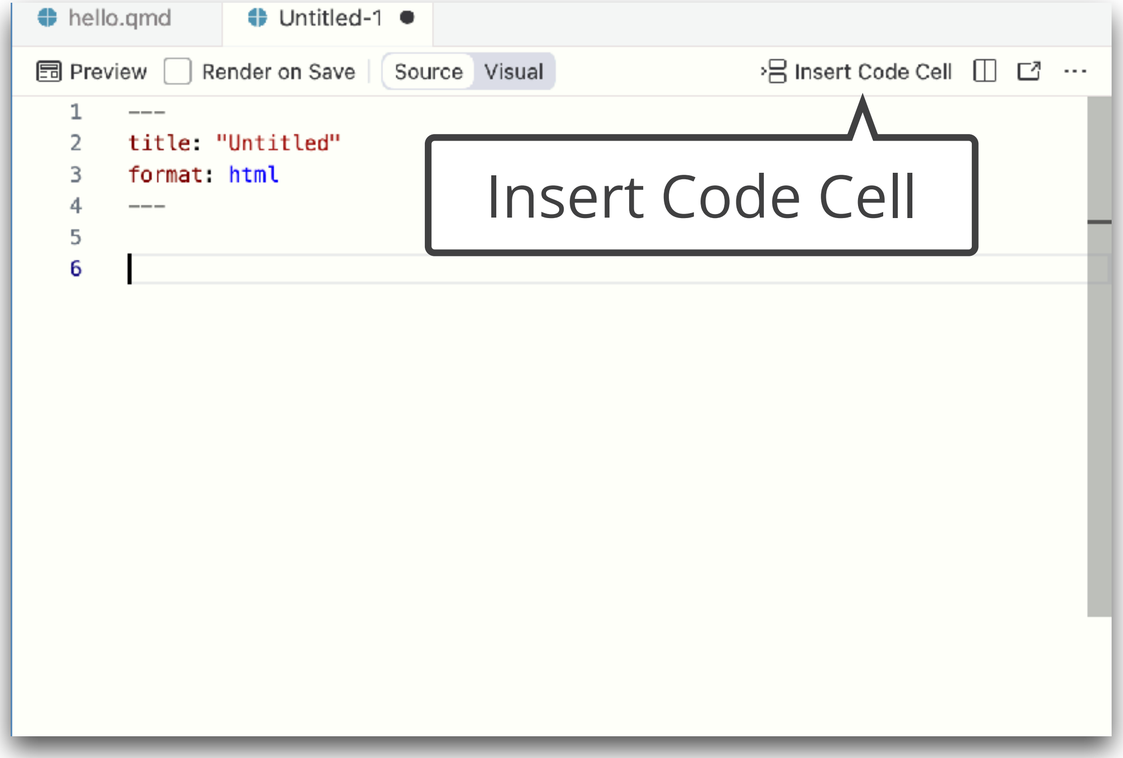
New > New File...



Command:

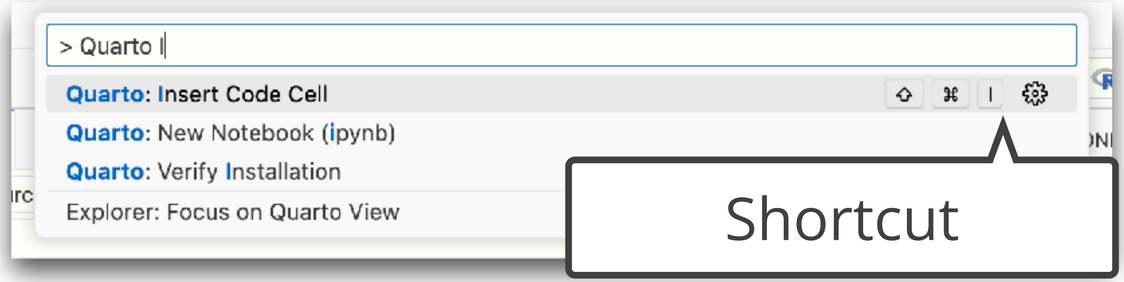
Quarto: New Document





Command:

Quarto: Insert Code Cell



What's different?

- Push button publishing to Posit Connect and Posit Connect Cloud via Posit Publisher extension
- RMarkdown (.Rmd) files preview via Quarto.
  Command palette: **R: Render with Document RMarkdown**

Updating Quarto

- **Strategy 1:** Rely entirely on Positron's bundled Quarto
  - Get updates as Positron is updated (⚙ Setting: Update: Auto Update)
  - Currently, no easy way to use this version outside of Positron
- **Strategy 2:** Manage Quarto outside of Positron
  - Update manually from quarto.org
  - Positron will prefer the manually installed version, even if it is older
- You can specify a specific Quarto with ⚙ Setting: Quarto: Path

Demo

Git Pane

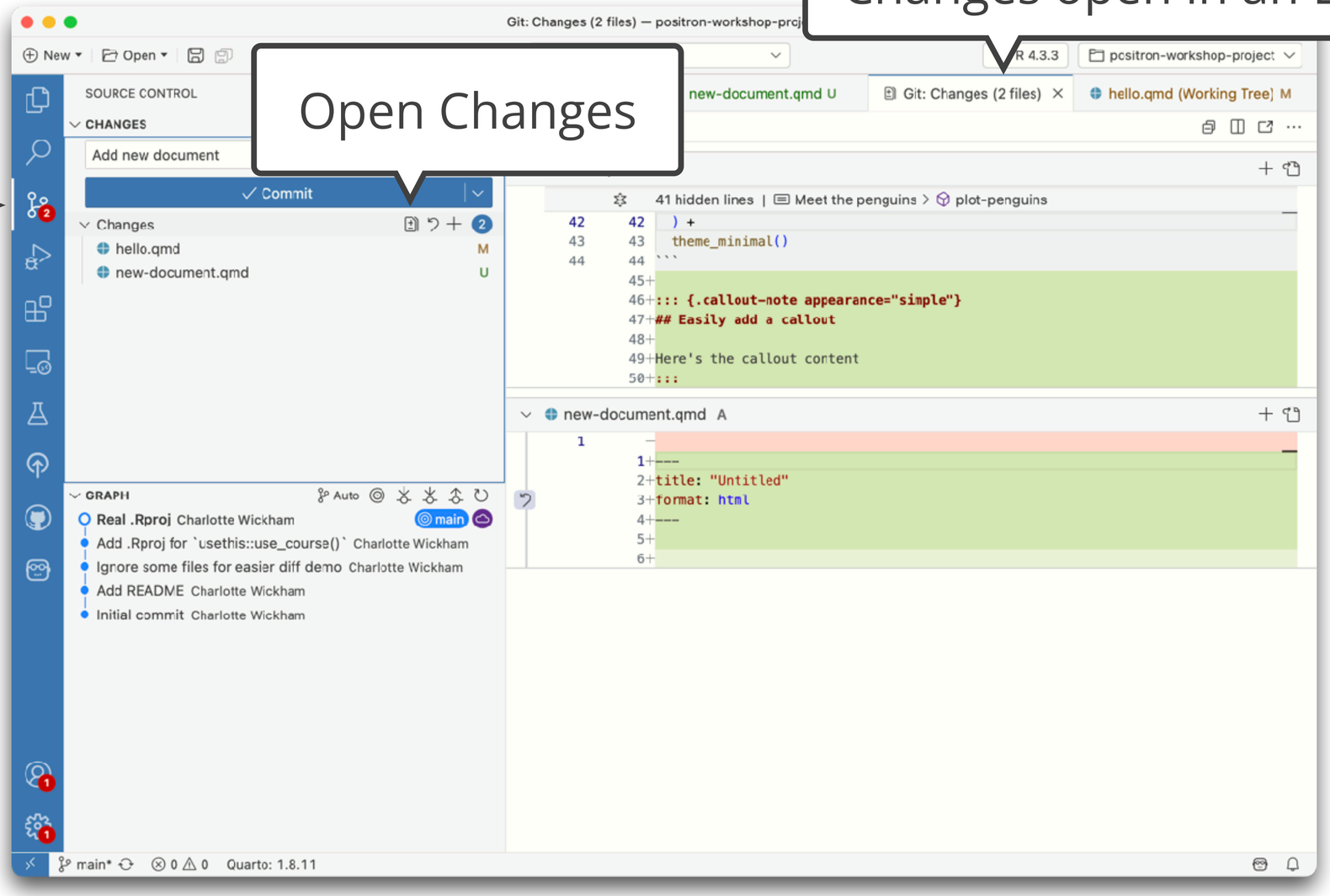
- Changes Pane
  - **Open Changes** closest to RStudio's diff
  - Changes open in Editor
  - Add, Commit
- Graph Pane
  - Pull/Push
  - Like RStudio's History view
- Current Branch
  - Click to get branch actions

Examine changes

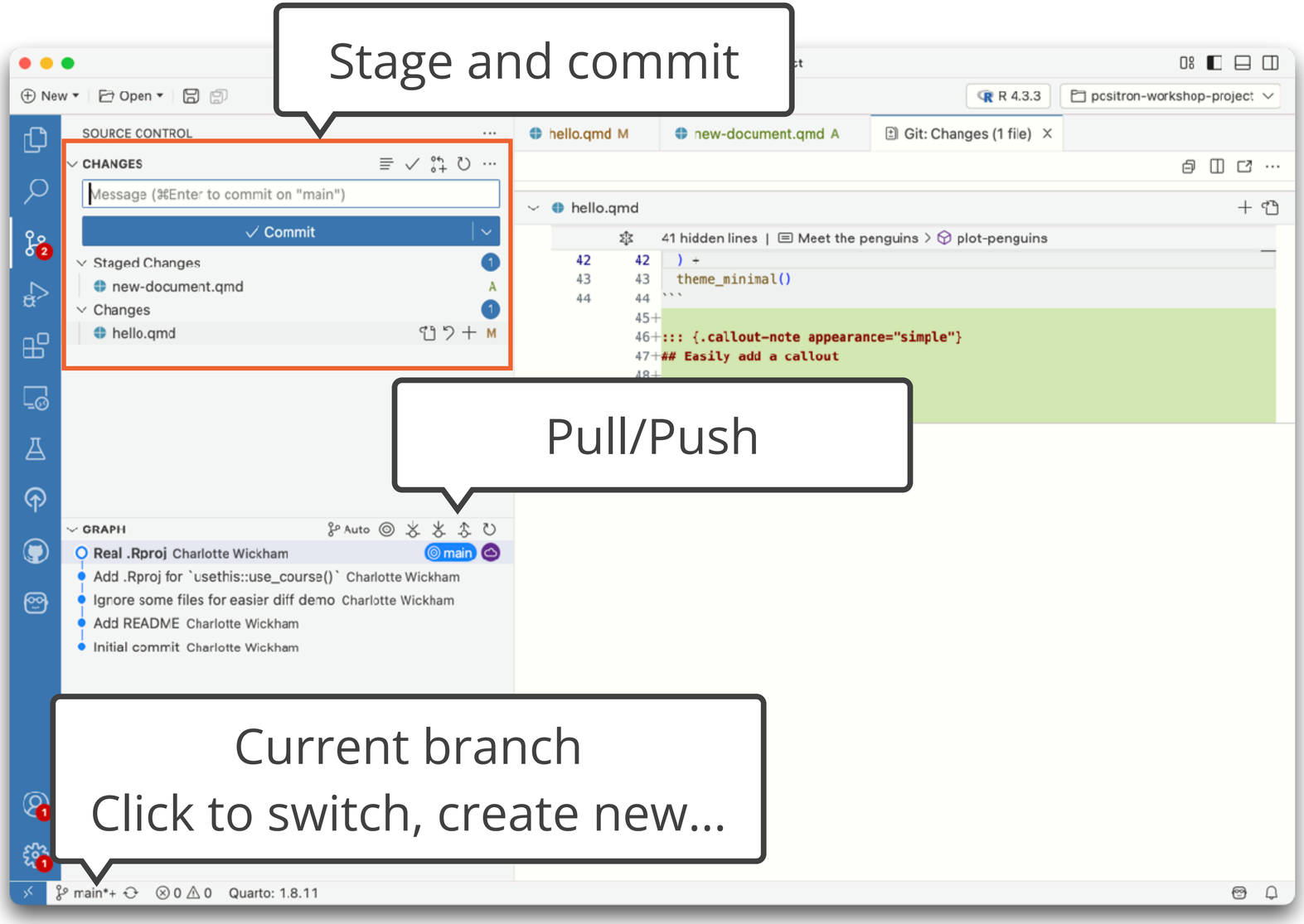
Changes open in an Editor

Open Changes

Git Pane



Git workflow



Learn more

Quarto docs: Guide > Tools > Positron

https://quarto.org/docs/tools/positron/

VS Code docs: Source Control

https://code.visualstudio.com/docs/sourcecontrol/overview